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A PROJECT REPORT

ON

Smart Travel Planner: An AI Agent for Personalized Itinerary Generation

A project report submitted in partial fulfilment of the requirements for the degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering

BACHELOR OF TECHNOLOGY COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

Submitted By
Insiya Hussain - 24070521156
Lakshika Jain - 24070521166
Radhika Sapate - 24070521185

UNDER THE GUIDANCE OF
Prof. Gagandeep Kaur

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING AY 2025-26

DEPARTMENT OF COMPUTER SCIENCE AND ENGINEERING

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the Project work entitled "**Smart Travel Planner: An AI Agent for Personalized Itinerary Generation**" is carried out by the Insiya Hussain , Lakshika Jain , Radhika Sapate in partial fulfilment for the award of the degree of **Bachelor of Technology** in **Computer Science and Engineering**, Symbiosis International (Deemed University), Pune during the academic year 2025-2026.

Prof. Gagandeep Kaur
International Cell In-charge

Dr. Gaurav Londhe
Associate Professor
Hack-O-Week In-Charge

Dr. Sagar Kumar Badhiye
HoD, Dept. of CSE,
SIT Nagpur

Dr. Bhupesh Kumar Dewangan
Associate Professor,
IPR Co-ordinator

DECLARATION

I hereby declare that the project titled "**Smart Travel Planner: An AI Agent for Personalized Itinerary Generation**" submitted to Symbiosis Institute of Technology, Constituent of Symbiosis International (Deemed University) Pune for the award of the degree of Bachelor of Technology in Computer Science and Engineering is a result of original research carried out by me. I understand that my report may be made electronically available to the public. It is further declared that the project report or any part thereof has not been previously submitted to any University or Institute for the award of any degree or diploma.

Name(s) of All Student(s) : Insiya Hussain , Lakshika Jain , Radhika Sapate

PRN: 24070521156 , 24070521166 , 24070521185

Degree: Bachelor of Technology in CSE

Department: Computer Science and Engineering

Title of the project: Smart Travel Planner: An AI Agent for Personalized Itinerary Generation

_____

(Signatures of the All Students)

Date:

ABSTRACT

Travel planning can be a complex and time-intensive process, where users have to search destinations, make schedules, and handle various preferences. This project introduces an AI-powered Travel Itinerary Planner that makes this process easier by generating a personalized travel plan automatically, depending on the input provided by the user in the form of destination, travel dates, budget, and interests.

The system involves the use of an AI agent that has the ability of Natural Language Processing (NLP) to interpret user queries in a conversational way. According to the information gathered, the system creates a structured, day-by-day scheduling comprising of suggested places to visit, activities and travelling suggestions. The model aims at delivering high efficiency and relevance of output with minimum computational needs.

The suggested system enhances the user experience through less manual work, personalized suggestions, and rapid decision-making. It can be implemented as a web or mobile application and may find its use in the tourism industry, travel agencies, and individual trip planning.

Keywords: AI Agent, Travel Itinerary, NLP, Personalization, Travel Planning System

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Chapter 1

Introduction

Travelling has been a vital aspect of living in the modern world to relax, do business, and explore the culture. Nevertheless, when it comes to planning a trip, there are several challenges to be encountered including destination selection, schedule, budgeting, and accommodation. This may be quite time consuming and daunting particularly to users who are not experienced or have access to credible information.

As the Artificial Intelligence (AI) is expanding rapidly, intelligent systems are designed to streamline and automate complicated tasks. Travel planning is one of the applications, as AI can process the preferences of users and create individualized itineraries. Conventional travel applications offer general suggestions and do not tend to fit the needs of each individual user.

The proposed project is an AI-powered Travel Itinerary Planner which serves as an intelligent assistant. The system will process user information that includes travel dates, destination, budget and interests and will produce a personalized day-by-day travel plan. The system is more user-friendly and interactive because it can comprehend the user queries in conversational format using Natural Language Processing (NLP).

The primary aim of this project is to minimise the effort needed to plan travel and offer efficient, customised and optimised travel itineraries.

Background and Technical Overview

The tourism sector has been growing tremendously over the years, thus necessitating more effective and intelligent traveling planning solutions. The internet offers a lot of information on destinations, hotels and activities through many online sites like travel websites and mobile apps. Nevertheless, these services tend to have fixed recommendations and leave the organization of the travel plans to the user.

The latest breakthroughs in AI and NLP have made it possible to create a system capable of comprehending human language and making intelligent recommendations. AI agents have the ability to process the inputs of the user, recognize preferences, and produce meaningful outputs, which is why they are very adaptable in applications such as itinerary planning.

Even with these improvements, most available systems are based on large and complicated models which may be computationally costly and less available to smaller applications. This introduces a demand of effective AI-based solutions that do not need to consume a lot of resources to produce accurate results.

The system is planned to be a travel itinerary planner that will be driven by AI and combines various technologies to create a personal travel plan.

Key Technologies Used

Artificial Intelligence (AI): To make a decision and generate an itinerary.

Natural Language Processing (NLP): To interpret queries by the user.

Machine Learning (optional): To enhance suggestions.

Web/Mobile Technologies: To interact with the users.

Working of the System.

User Input:

The user will input information about destination, dates of travel, budget and preferences.

Data Processing:

The NLP module takes the input and pulls out important information such as the location, duration and interests.

AI Agent Processing:

The AI agent processes the data obtained, choosing places, activities, and schedules.

Itinerary Generation:

The system creates a day-by-day travel plan that is organized.

Output Display:

The final itinerary is presented to the user in an easy-to-understand format.

Chapter 2

2.1 Problem Statement

The process of creating a travel itinerary can be a very hectic affair that demands users to browse through numerous resources to acquire destinations, accommodation, transportation and things to do. The current travel websites are generally offering generic suggestions and do not have the capability to know the likes and dislikes of individual users like, budget, travel days and personal interest.

Besides, users will have to plan their travel schedules manually, which may result in inefficient planning, missed opportunities, and more work. Natural language interaction is also not supported by many existing systems, which makes them less user-friendly and understandable.

Thus, a smart system is needed that is able to interpret user needs automatically and create tailor-made and well-designed travel plans. The system must have the ability to accept user inputs in a conversational style and give optimal travel plans that lessen manual load and improve the eventual travel planning process.

2.2 Motivation

The process of travel planning may be stressful and time-consuming since these activities are associated with the necessity to find a destination, compare it with the other options, and arrange a full schedule. It is not easy to design a well-structured itinerary that suits the preferences, budget and time constraint of many users.

Current travel websites are characterized by lack of personalization and many times one has to manually design plans. This results in inefficiency and deteriorates the travelling experience. Moreover, the process is not so interactive and user-friendly, as there are no intelligent and conversational systems.

This project is driven by the desire to create an AI-based application that would make it easy to plan a trip by automating the itinerary development process. The system will tailor individual, effective, and fast travel plans using an AI agent who can comprehend the user inputs.

The development of AI-based solutions that are more practical and accessible, as well as enhance user experience via smart suggestions and less manual work, is also the aim of this project.

Chapter 3

3.1 What Makes This Project New

This project is unique in the sense that it relies on Artificial Intelligence whereby a simple system is used to develop a travel itinerary planner that is capable of comprehending what the user desires and provides a comprehensive travel plan. The majority of travel planning systems are not very personalized and complex, whereas this system aims at simplification and user needs.

Some of the main aspects that render this project new are:

i. We are applying AI to get to know what the user writes and develop travel plans.

ii. The system has the capability to comprehend typical sentences, such as Plan a 3-day trip to Goa and is thus simple to use.

iii. It prepares a fully day by day itinerary and does not require the user to plan everything out.

iv. The system provides customized recommendations according to the user preferences such as the budget and interests.

v. It is real-time and therefore the users obtain speedy results.

vi. It is easy to operate and does not consume heavy resources, hence is efficient and practical.

3.2 New Ideas

This project has some ideas:

1. Front-End to Back-End Integration: This allows the user interface and the system to communicate easily so that user inputs can be processed and results can be shown properly.

2. Real-Time Itinerary Generation: The system quickly generates travel plans so the user gets instant results without waiting.

3. AI-Based Understanding: The system uses simple AI and NLP techniques to understand what the user wants and generate suitable travel plans.

4. User-Friendly Interface: The planner is easy to use and allows users to enter their travel details in a simple way.

5. Personalized Planning: The system creates customized itineraries based on user preferences like budget, duration, and interests.

Chapter 4

4.1 Technical Advantages

This project has several technical advantages:

1. Quick Processing: The system is fast in processing travel itineraries and provides the user with immediate results.
2. Resource Usage: It is not a heavy computation and thus can be used in the normal systems.
3. Easy Integration: The system can be easily connected with websites or mobile applications.
4. Simple AI Implementation: Uses simple AI and NLP algorithms, and is simpler to build and maintain.
5. Real-Time Response: The system receives user input, and responds instantly.

4.2 Practical Usefulness

This project is useful in real-world applications:

1. Saves Time: Users do not need to manually plan trips, as the system does it automatically.
2. Easy to Use: Anyone can use it without technical knowledge.
3. Personalized Travel Plans: It provides customized itineraries based on user preferences.
4. Helpful for Tourists: Tourists can quickly plan trips without confusion.
5. Useful for Travel Agencies: It can assist customers in planning trips.
6. Improves User Experience: It makes travel planning simple, fast, and stress-free.

Chapter 5

5.1 Methodology

Developing an itinerary planning system using AI technologies is simple, and the process requires following certain guidelines.

The procedure is quite simple, as follows:

Step 1: Design

Step 2: Implementation

Step 3: Testing

The system can be designed using HTML as the front-end and Python as the back-end programming language.

The basic purpose behind this project is to simplify the process of trip planning using an interactive AI system.

The first step towards achieving the objective is to design the front-end of the interface from where users can provide travel-related information.

The interface serves as a simple data entry point and facilitates easy user interaction.

Whenever a person provides some information regarding his/her trip, the same is submitted to the backend of the system.

Once the information reaches the backend, the system processes the request using AI and NLP.

The system tries to understand what the user is asking, extract relevant inputs such as location, number of days, and interest area.

Based on the processing, the system prepares the required itinerary.

This includes day-wise itinerary along with the list of activities.

The final output is delivered back to the frontend.

The entire itinerary is shown on the user interface screen. The cycle continues whenever the user inputs fresh data, providing new arrangements for their trip.The whole process is made interactive, thus allowing the user to plan their trip easily and quickly.

5. 2 System Architecture

1. Frontend (User Interface):-

• The frontend is the visible and interactive component of the system for the user.

• It is coded in HTML and helps users provide information about their travel such as location, duration, and preferences.

• It shows the travel itinerary generated by the system in a neat way.

• The frontend is created to make the system user-friendly.

2. Backend (Processing Unit):-

• The backend comprises all the inner workings of the software.

• It is programmed in Python and processes the inputs provided by the user.

• It uses some of the most fundamental concepts of AI and Natural Language Processing.

• It creates a good travel itinerary for the user from the data provided by him.

3. Logic Layer:-

• The logic layer consists of all the logic and rules used to create the travel itinerary.

• It analyses the user inputs and makes them compatible with the travel information available.

• It selects appropriate places and activities based on the user preferences.

• It also organizes the itinerary according to the days of the trip.

5. 3 Working Flow of the System

The input of travel information, which includes destination, number of days, budget, etc., by the user is done through the HTML interface.

• Input of data from the HTML interface is forwarded to the backend part of the system.

• Analysis of the information provided by the user is done through simple use of artificial intelligence and natural language processing.

• The analysis leads to a day-by-day plan of travel that is best suited for the user.

• The travel itinerary produced is sent back to the front end of the system.

• The output of information is done on the HTML interface and shown to the user.

• This procedure will be continuously performed whenever the user gives input.

5. 4 Technologies Used

HTML - For designing the UI and enabling users to provide their travel information

Python - For back-end operations and preparing the travel plan

Basic Natural Language Processing Techniques - For interpreting user queries and extracting crucial information such as destinations, duration, etc.

Chapter 6

6.1 Existing Travel Planner Systems

The planning systems for travels are not new in existence. Previously, people would rely on travel websites and guides to plan their travel manually. These were the planning systems that offered basic information related to destinations, accommodation facilities, and available activities in these destinations.

Previously, people had to go through the process of searching for each destination by themselves, planning the schedule, and planning the whole journey manually.

But currently, many travel systems are making use of artificial intelligence and data analysis techniques to offer recommendations based on the user's requirements.

These systems do not:

• Offer fully personalized travel plans

• Automate the whole travel planning procedure

• Understand the user's inputs completely and automatically

For this reason, there is a need for an advanced travel-planning system that understands users' input and offers an automated plan for travels.

6.2 Review of Existing Approaches

• Rule-Based Systems:

The systems are designed according to the set of rules that guide their working. The developer sets up rules regarding how the system would react to user inputs.

• They are easy to develop and implement

• They follow logical reasoning

• They fail to comprehend user requirements fully

• They offer limited flexibility and outputs

• AI-Based Systems:

The systems utilize artificial intelligence and natural language processing capabilities to analyze and produce outputs based on user inputs.

• They comprehend user requirements more efficiently

• They offer personalized suggestions

• They rely heavily on computing resources

• They can become complicated and expensive to construct

The latest travel planning systems are developed using cloud-based platforms. Such systems perform effectively, yet they are quite costly and intricate.

Travel planning systems are extensively applied in the present world, although there is an increasing need for improved designs.

6.3 Limitations of Existing Systems

• Majority of systems give generic advice and lack full knowledge of user preferences.

• Users have to plan and arrange the trip on their own, which is time-consuming and effortful.

• Most systems do not allow natural language input, which reduces interaction with users.

• Limitations of rule-based systems, as well as inability to perform complex tasks.

• High expenses for AI-based systems that also require significant computing power.

• Complicated systems that are difficult to operate.

• Absence of personalization, as well as flexibility in planning.

• Need for using different platforms to finalize planning process.

6.4 Proposed System in Comparison

AI Travel Itinerary Planner addresses several limitations associated with the current applications.

• Current applications provide generic suggestions; however, the proposed application offers personalized travel itineraries according to the user's preference.

• In current applications, the user needs to create his/her travel itinerary himself/herself, while the proposed application offers an automatic generation of a comprehensive itinerary for each day.

• Most of the current platforms cannot interpret the user's commands in natural language; however, the proposed application interprets user commands in simple sentences.

• Rule-based applications are restrictive; however, the proposed application uses artificial intelligence technology to offer more flexible and improved results.

• AI-based current applications might become complicated and expensive to operate; however, the proposed application is simpler and cheaper.

• The user needs to use different platforms in current applications; however, the proposed application integrates everything in a single platform.

• The proposed application offers instant results to the user, improving user experience.

Chapter 7

7.1 Applications of the Travel Planner

• Personal Travel Planning: It is easy for users to plan personal travel according to their choices, budget, and schedule.

• Tourism Industry: Tour agencies can use it to assist customers with personalized travel itineraries.

• Mobile and Web Applications: Integration with travel applications can make travel plans easier for users.

• Travel Assistant Applications: Such software can act as an assistant application helping users in planning travels.

• Education Purpose: It can be useful for students who wish to understand the process of travel planning.

• Smart Tourism: It can be a component of smart cities/smart tourism system.

• Travel Customer Support: It can help answer users' questions regarding travels and provide suggestions.

7.2 Deployment Areas

The itinerary planner software for travel can be applied using a variety of devices according to requirement. The application can be embedded into travel websites and act as an itinerary planner for those who visit the website for travel planning purposes. The itinerary planner software for travel can also be used in mobile apps. Visitors will fill up forms and get itineraries immediately suggested to them based on their input.

Travel agencies can benefit from the application to give quick and efficient solutions to their customers about travel planning matters. Tourism websites and platforms can incorporate the software in their platform and serve their tourist clients much better. The software can also be used as an artificial assistant that will respond to visitors' inquiries.

The application can be employed by firms working in the sphere of tourism and hotels to provide assistance to workers regarding customer service issues. The system is rather easy to apply, requiring only little resources.

Chapter 8

8.1 Conclusion

The Travel Itinerary Planner using AI technology is a very useful and practical tool to make one's trip planning easier and faster. This system decreases the burden of manual planning by creating an entire travel itinerary automatically.

The AI technology and natural language processing used in this application make it quite simple and user-friendly. This application can be used by various users without any complications.

This particular application depicts the power of AI in solving real-world problems such as trip planning and improving the experience of travelers.

The proposed system is very efficient, easy to use, and even more improvements can be made in the future.

8.2 Future Scope

More enhancements can be made in this project in future.

• Integration with real-time data, including weather and traffic updates can be done.

• Integration with booking systems of hotels and flights can be done to provide total travel packages.

• Voice-based inputs can be included so that users don’t have to type anything.

• Multi-language capabilities can be introduced in order to assist travelers from all around the world.

• New and enhanced artificial intelligence techniques can be employed in order to enhance performance.

• The system can be designed to improve its suggestions based on user reviews and experiences.

• The web portal can be transformed into a mobile app.

• Navigation services can be provided using maps and directions.

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